

a sense of confidence on a Monday morning, and knowing what was coming in and what was going out that week meant that I didn't have to feel that bubbling anxiety about unexpected bills and bouncing direct debits. In the beginning, I sometimes had to push myself to open the spreadsheet and sit down, but eventually it became something that I started looking forward to. It's a method that I've expanded out into other areas too – such as saving my favourite podcasts for when I have to force myself to wash up, or watching *New Girl* for the thousandth time while I fold the laundry. Lots of these things that fall under the umbrella of 'life admin', such as money management and household chores, are actually base-level self-care, but that doesn't mean that they're exciting, or that having something to sweeten the deal won't make them more enjoyable.

Can you think about some ways that you can create rituals around your own management of your finances, or any ways that you can bundle your habits to make looking after your money feel like part of your self-care? Have a think about whether there are times in the week that you could use effectively to look after yourself by creating enjoyable moments that are actually also positively contributing to your financial wellbeing.

In terms of making your new habits **easy**, Clear's suggestions are very aligned with things that we've already covered, such as simplifying, streamlining and automating, also applying his titular principle of scaling down these desirable habits so that